Harry's Upwork profile plan: Short-form video editor

This plan comes from the October 2026 study of about 80 short-form video editors on Upwork and 46 live job posts. Everything here is honest: no fake clients, numbers or employers.

1. How editors reach $100K+ (what the data shows)

Every editor in the study who has earned $100K+ got there the same way:

1. **Many small jobs first.** Hafsa H. ($70K+) has 508 jobs. Khoa Nguyen B. ($100K+) has 479. Most started with $10–$50 jobs.
2. **Then a few long monthly clients.** Paula E. (Abuja) has one $10,135 contract. Hassan H. got a $6,050 contract 11 months after a $15 first job. Emmanuel O. earned $8,429 from one "100 videos/month" client.
3. **They pick one buyer type.** Ads and UGC (Reid N., Serhii K.), podcasts (Fahad T., $200K+), real estate (Hammad H.) and talking-head videos (Abdullah D.).
4. **They stay consistent.** Each one keeps the same title, overview and portfolio for years, and keeps delivering fast.

Your path in numbers. $100K means about $2,800 a month for 3 years. That is 4–6 monthly clients paying $400–$700 each, or one or two big retainers plus small jobs. Getting your first 10 reviews is the hardest part.

2. Changes I can make for you (need your "yes")

A. Title (67 characters)

Now: Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok & YouTube Shorts

New: Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok & YouTube Shorts | Podcasts

Why: it keeps all the search words you have now and adds "podcast", one of the three best-paying niches (podcast clips appeared in 22% of jobs).

B. Overview (upgrade)

The new version keeps your current text and adds three things:

- **"Who I work with"**: coaches, podcasters, creators, brands and agencies, the buyers who pay monthly.
- **Monthly packages**: this is how editors get retainers, the main route to $100K.

- **A keyword line at the end**: 15 of the 40 top-ranking editors use one, and Upwork search reads the overview.

Full text:

> Your long videos have great moments. Most people never see them, because they're buried in a 60-minute podcast or a raw talking-head video.
>
> I turn your long-form content and raw footage into short, scroll-stopping clips for Instagram Reels, TikTok and YouTube Shorts. Each clip has a strong hook in the first 3 seconds, clean captions and pacing that keeps people watching to the end.
>
> WHO I WORK WITH Podcasters, coaches, founders, content creators, e-commerce brands and marketing agencies who need fresh short-form content every week.
>
> WHAT I EDIT • Podcast and interview clips: I find the best moments, so you don't have to • Talking-head videos for coaches, founders and personal brands • Reels, TikToks and Shorts from your raw footage • UGC-style and AI video ads for brands and online stores • Repurposing one long video into 10–30 short clips
>
> WHAT EVERY CLIP GETS • A hook in the first 1–3 seconds • Animated captions that are easy to read on mobile, with or without sound • Fast cuts, zooms, B-roll, sound effects and background music • 9:16 vertical format, exported for Reels, TikTok and Shorts • Your branding: fonts, colours and logo
>
> HOW WE WORK
>
> 1. Send me your footage (Google Drive or Dropbox) and 1–2 reference videos you like.
> 2. I send the first clip within 24–48 hours.
> 3. You give feedback, and I apply up to 2 rounds of revisions.
> 4. Once you're happy with the style, I edit the rest in batches, on time, every week.
>
> MONTHLY PACKAGES (ongoing content) • Starter: 8 clips a month • Growth: 16 clips a month • Scale: 30 clips a month, for podcasts and agencies Message me for a quote. Single clips and one-off projects are welcome too.
>
> TOOLS • Adobe Premiere Pro and CapCut (desktop), with editable project files on request • AI tools for speed and extra content: Opus Clip, ElevenLabs (voiceover), Higgsfield, Kling and Veo (AI video and B-roll) AI helps me work faster, but every clip is chosen, cut and checked by me. No lazy auto-clips.
>
> TRY ME RISK-FREE Send me one raw clip and I'll edit the first 15–30 seconds for free, so you can see my style before you hire me.
>
> I work from Lagos (GMT+1), reply fast and keep files and communication on Upwork. Click "Invite to Job" and tell me about your content. I'll reply with how I'd edit it.

> Short-Form Video Editor | Reels Editor | TikTok Video Editor | YouTube Shorts Editor | Podcast Clips Editor | Talking-Head Video Editor | UGC Video Editor | Video Repurposing | CapCut | Premiere Pro

C. Remove the 20 Roblox employment entries

These are the entries you chose to remove. If the connection fails again, you can delete them yourself in about 5 minutes.

D. Add 3 "Other experience" entries

These describe your skills and process. They don't claim any clients.

1. Podcast & Long-Form to Short-Form Repurposing

> I turn long podcasts, interviews, webinars and YouTube videos into short clips for Reels, TikTok and YouTube Shorts. I watch the full recording and pick the moments that work on their own: a strong opinion, a story, a useful tip or a funny reaction. Each clip gets a hook in the first 3 seconds, clean cuts that remove pauses and filler words, animated captions, and a clear ending, so it makes sense to someone who never saw the full episode. One episode usually gives 8–20 clips. I deliver them in 9:16, with titles and caption ideas, so you can post every day without recording more content.

2. Hooks, Captions & Retention Editing for Reels, TikTok and Shorts

> Short-form video is won or lost in the first 3 seconds. I edit for retention: I open with the strongest line or visual, cut every dead second, add pattern interrupts (zooms, B-roll, sound effects, text pops) every few seconds, and use word-by-word animated captions that work with the sound off. I follow each platform's safe zones so captions and buttons never cover each other, and I match your brand fonts and colours. Every video is checked on a phone before delivery.

3. AI-Assisted Video Workflow (Opus Clip, ElevenLabs, Higgsfield, Kling, Veo)

> I use AI tools to work faster and add more value, not to replace editing. Opus Clip helps me scan long videos for possible moments, which I then review and cut by hand. ElevenLabs creates clean voiceovers for faceless content and ads. Higgsfield, Kling and Veo generate AI B-roll, product shots and short AI video scenes when there is not enough real footage. Every final video is edited in Premiere Pro or CapCut and checked by me, so you get speed without the generic "AI look".

D2. Remove the old Roblox "Other experience" entries

Upwork's tools can't see these, so you need to delete them yourself: **Profile → Other experiences → bin icon** on each Roblox entry.

E. Education

- **Keep:** University of Lagos (BCompSc).
- **Remove from Education:** the 2 Roblox Udemy courses. They don't match video editing. Your Roblox *certifications* can stay or go, as you prefer.

3. Things only you can do (in the Upwork app or website)

1. **Portfolio (most important).** Upload 6–8 vertical clips. Use real client work if you have it, or practice edits clearly labelled "Sample edit". Title each one in the "Format | Platform | Niche" style:
   - Podcast Clip | TikTok & Reels | Hook + Animated Captions
   - Talking-Head Reel | Coach Content | Instagram Reels
   - YouTube Shorts Edit | Long-Form to Short-Form Repurposing
   - UGC Video Ad | TikTok & Meta | E-commerce Product
   - AI Video Ad | Higgsfield + Premiere Pro | Product Brand
   - Before / After | Raw Footage to Scroll-Stopping Reel Use a cover image with big text (e.g. "BEFORE / AFTER", "PODCAST CLIP"). Delete all Roblox portfolio items.
2. **Video introduction (+10 free Connects).** Record a 60-second phone video and upload it to YouTube (public or unlisted). Send me the link and I'll add it. Script:

   > "Hi, I'm Harry, a short-form video editor from Lagos. I turn podcasts, talking-head videos and raw footage into Reels, TikToks and YouTube Shorts that people watch to the end: strong hooks, clean captions and fast pacing. I edit in Premiere Pro and CapCut and use AI tools to work faster, but every clip is cut by me. Send me one raw clip and I'll edit the first 15 seconds for free. Click Invite, and let's make your content work."

3. **Project Catalog.** Pause the 5 Roblox projects. Create these 3:
   - "Podcast to Short-Form Clips for TikTok, Reels & YouTube Shorts". Basic 3 clips $45 / Standard 8 clips $110 / Premium 16 clips $200.
   - "Short-Form Video Editing for Reels, TikTok & YouTube Shorts". $15 / $40 / $75 per 1 / 3 / 6 clips.
   - "UGC & AI Video Ad Editing for TikTok and Meta". $30 / $75 / $140 per 1 / 3 / 6 ads with hook variations.
4. **Rate.** Keep $18/hr on your profile. For the first 3–5 jobs, quote $10–$30 per clip to win reviews. Raise prices after 10 reviews.
5. **Consultation.** Turn on a $15 "30-min Short-Form Content Review" call. Most top profiles offer one.

6. **Languages.** German, Spanish, Italian and Portuguese at "Basic" don't help and can look padded. Keep English (Fluent) and French (Conversational) only if they're true.

4. How to apply, daily (where the money starts)

- Send 2–4 proposals a day to jobs posted in the last 24 hours with fewer than 10 proposals and payment verified.
- Open with the client's platform and deliverable: "I'll turn your podcast into 10 TikTok and Reels clips with hooks and captions."
- Link the one sample that matches the job. Offer a small paid test.
- Skip $5 "expert" jobs, unpaid tests, "unlimited revisions" and requests to move to WhatsApp.
- Deliver within 24–48 hours, ask happy clients for a review, then offer a monthly package.